

ANTIHERO AI · LIVE GUIDE · FREE

BUILD A BRAND FROM SCRATCH WITH AI.

Your why, your look, your voice, and one document your AI reads before it writes a single word for you. Logo, fonts, colors, backgrounds, brand voice and 18 long copy-paste prompts. The demo uses Grok Bot. Any decent AI works.

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 1, 2026 · FACEBOOK LIVE

WHAT'S INSIDE

A brand isn't a logo. It's what people feel about you when you're not in the room. The logo is just the name tag. This guide walks you through building the whole thing, in order, with AI doing the heavy lifting and you doing the deciding.

- 01 **Start with why.** The Golden Circle, why people buy you, five talks worth your time
- 02 **Steal like an artist.** Gather context before you make anything
- 03 **Your mood folder.** What to collect, where to find it, brands to study
- 04 **Story, archetype, positioning.** Who you are, who you're for, who you're not for
- 05 **Color.** Psychology (with the honest caveats), 60-30-10, contrast
- 06 **Typography.** Two fonts, free sources, pairings that work
- 07 **Logo.** Types, tests, the files you actually need
- 08 **Backgrounds and templates.** Imagery rules and a social system
- 09 **Brand voice.** Three traits, banned words, rewrites, tagline
- 10 **The brand brain.** One doc your AI reads first, every time
- 11 **Checklist and mistakes.** What brand people check, and what everyone gets wrong
- 12 **Run of show, cheat sheet, links.** Tonight's timings, every prompt on one page, every link

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Work top to bottom in **one long chat** with your AI, so it remembers everything you've decided. Every section ends with prompts. Text in **[red brackets]** is yours to fill in. Don't skip the why. Everyone wants to skip the why. That's why everyone's brand looks the same.

ANY AI The demo tonight uses Grok Bot because it can browse, make images, work with files and build the PDF at the end. ChatGPT, Claude or Gemini will do most of it too. The thinking is the part that matters, and the thinking is yours.

The AntiHero AI group teaches you to do this stuff yourself instead of paying monthly for an AI wrapper with a logo on it. It's free and it sells nothing.



PART ONE

START WITH WHY.

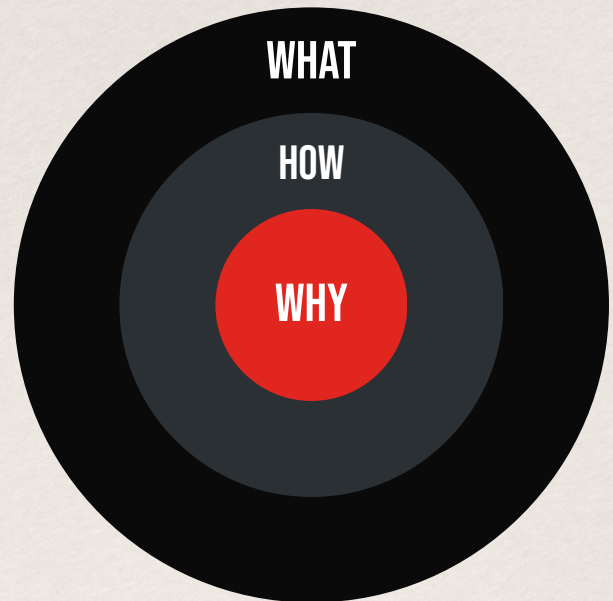
Before fonts, before colors, before you ask an AI for a logo, figure out why you exist. Otherwise you'll get a very pretty brand for nobody.

PEOPLE BUY WHY YOU DO IT.

In 2009 Simon Sinek gave a TEDx talk with a marker and a flip chart. It's now one of the most watched talks on TED. His idea fits on a napkin: three circles.

- **WHAT** you do. Everyone knows this. It's the product.
- **HOW** you do it. Your process, your difference. Some people know this.
- **WHY** you do it. Your purpose, your belief. Almost nobody can say it out loud. Profit is not a why. Profit is a result.

Most brands talk from the outside in: here's what we sell, here's why it's great, please buy it. The ones people love talk from the inside out: here's what we believe, here's how we act on it, and by the way, here's the thing we make.



"People don't buy what you do, they buy why you do it."

Simon Sinek, How Great Leaders Inspire Action (TEDxPuget Sound, 2009)

WHY THIS MATTERS EVEN MORE NOW

AI can make anyone's logo in thirty seconds. It can write anyone's website by lunch. The product is getting easier to copy every month. You are not. Your story, your opinions, your weird history, the way you treat people: that's the part nobody can generate. People buy **you**, not the stuff. Small brands win because the person is visible. So be visible.

WATCH Watch the talk before you start. It's 18 minutes. [ted.com](https://www.ted.com) or [YouTube](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1s2Btq0F8E8).

WATCH THESE FIRST

SPEAKER	TALK	WHY IT'S HERE	LINK
Simon Sinek	How great leaders inspire action	The Golden Circle. If you watch one, watch this.	watch
Seth Godin	How to get your ideas to spread	Safe is risky. Be remarkable or be invisible. Purple cows.	watch
Seth Godin	The tribes we lead	People want to belong to something. Lead them. Brand as a movement, not a megaphone.	watch
Andrew Stanton	The clues to a great story	The Pixar writer on story: make me care. Useful for your brand story section.	watch
Austin Kleon	Steal like an artist (TEDxKC)	Nothing is original. Collect, remix, credit, make it yours. Next section.	watch

On a Facebook Live, link the talks instead of playing them. Rights holders' auto-detection doesn't care how inspiring the clip is.

MARTY NEUMEIER'S DEFINITION, WORTH STEALING

Neumeier, author of *The Brand Gap*, defines a brand as "a person's gut feeling about a product, service or organization." Translation: it isn't what you say it is. It's what they say it is. Your job is to give them good reasons to feel something specific. martyneumeier.com.

PROMPT 01 · WHY FINDER

You are a brand strategist who has read Simon Sinek's "Start With Why" twice and has zero patience for corporate mush. Your job is to find the WHY behind my brand.

About me: I'm [your name]. I run (or I'm starting) [business or project] for [who it's for] in [city, region or online].

How to run this:

- Ask me one question at a time and wait for my answer before the next one.
- Ask at least 12 questions. Mix the easy ones (why did you start this) with the uncomfortable ones (what makes you angry about your industry, what would you keep doing if nobody paid you, what do you say at a party when someone asks what you do and you can see their eyes glaze).
- When I give a vague answer like "I want to help people", push back. Ask for a specific moment, a specific person, a specific day.
- Dig for the origin story: a frustration, a turning point, someone who did it badly and made me think "I can do better".

When you have enough, give me:

1. My WHY in one sentence, in this format: "To [contribution] so that [impact]."
2. My HOW: 3 to 5 principles or behaviors that make me different from the others.
3. My WHAT: a plain-English description of what I sell, no jargon.
4. Three versions of a one-line belief I could put on my website, from safe to bold.
5. The single best story from my answers that proves the WHY, 120 words, first person, in my words.

Use my own words wherever you can. If anything I said sounds like it came off a motivational poster, call it out and ask me again.

THE DISCOVERY INTERVIEW

A real brand agency starts every job with a discovery session. It costs thousands because it takes hours and somebody has to ask the awkward questions. Your AI will ask them for free and it doesn't get bored. Budget 30 to 45 minutes. Answer out loud with voice typing if you can. You'll say better stuff than you'd type.

PROMPT 02 • BRAND DISCOVERY INTERVIEW

Act as a senior brand strategist running a paid discovery session with a new client. I'm the client. Interview me, then write my Brand Discovery Brief. This brief will be the foundation for my name, logo, colors, fonts and voice, so do it properly.

My starting point: **[business name or "no name yet"]**, **[what I sell]**, **[who buys it]**, **[how long I've been doing it]**, **[what I charge, roughly]**.

Interview me in five rounds. One question at a time. Wait for each answer.

Round 1, the business: what I sell, what problem it solves, what a customer's life looks like before and after, why someone would pick me over doing nothing.

Round 2, the people: my best customer ever (describe them), my worst customer ever, where my customers hang out online and offline, what they're tired of hearing.

Round 3, the competition: who else they could buy from, what those brands get right, what they all do that's boring or annoying.

Round 4, the personality: if my brand walked into a bar, who would it be; three words I want people to use about me; three words I never want to hear; brands I love from any industry and why.

Round 5, the practical stuff: budget, deadlines, where the brand shows up first (Facebook, website, truck wrap, packaging), anything I'm keeping (an old logo, a color I'm attached to).

Rules: if an answer is vague, ask a follow-up. If I contradict myself, point it out. Don't move to the next round until you understand this one.

Then write the brief with these headings: The Business in One Paragraph, The Why (draft), Ideal Customer, Competitors and the Sea of Sameness, Personality (3 traits, plus 3 anti-traits), Visual Direction Notes, Must-Haves and Never-Evers, Open Questions. End with the 3 biggest risks to this brand, stated bluntly.

Save the brief it gives you. You'll paste it into almost every prompt after this one.

STEAL LIKE AN ARTIST

"The secret to creativity is knowing how to hide your sources."

Usually credited to Albert Einstein. He almost certainly never said it. Quote Investigator traces it to the writer C. E. M. Joad in 1926 ("the height of originality is skill in concealing origins"), and the Einstein version shows up in 1989, decades after he died. [Source](#). Which is funny, because the quote hid its own source.

Whoever said it, the point stands. Every brand you admire is a remix of things its makers loved. Austin Kleon wrote a whole book about this, *Steal Like an Artist*: nothing is completely original, so collect what moves you, study it, mix it, and turn it into something that's yours. austinkleon.com/steal.

GOOD THEFT VERSUS BAD THEFT

STEAL THIS

The structure: how a brand tells its story, the order of a homepage, how a template is built

The principle: why a color works, why the copy is funny

From many places, including outside your industry

NEVER THIS

Their logo, their exact colors, their tagline, their photos

One brand, copied whole. That's not stealing, that's cosplay

Only from your direct competitors, which is how everyone ends up beige

THE RULE

Gather context before you make anything. An AI with no context gives you the average of the internet, and the average of the internet is a blue logo with a swoosh. Feed it your taste and it gives you something with a pulse.

PROMPT 03 · COMPETITOR TEARDOWN

Act as a ruthless but fair brand analyst. I'm building a brand for [your business] aimed at [your customer]. Here are [3 to 5] competitors or brands in my space:

1. [name] [website or social link]
2. [name] [link]
3. [name] [link]

[Optional: I've attached screenshots of their homepages, logos and recent posts.]

If you can browse, look at their websites, social pages and customer reviews. If you can't, work from the screenshots and tell me what you can't see.

For each competitor give me:

- Positioning in one sentence (what they want to be known for)
- Who they're really talking to
- Personality in 3 adjectives
- Visual identity: colors (hex guesses), type style, logo type, photo style
- Voice: 2 or 3 typical phrases they use
- What they do better than anyone
- Where they're generic, weak or forgettable
- What customers complain about

Then:

1. A comparison table across all of them.
2. The Sea of Sameness: the colors, words, photos and promises everyone uses. These are the things I should avoid.
3. Three white-space opportunities: positions nobody owns that fit me.
4. What I should steal (structure and ideas, never surface: no copying their logo, colors or slogans).
5. One sentence on how I could be the obvious choice for a specific customer they're all ignoring.

YOUR MOOD FOLDER

Make one folder on your computer. Name it after your brand, or after your dog if you don't have a name yet. For one week, every time something catches your eye, screenshot it and drop it in. Aim for 30 to 60 things. Don't judge yet.

- **Fonts** you like (and two you hate)
- **Logos and brands** from any industry
- **Websites** that feel right
- **Photos**: light, places, moods
- **Packaging, signs, menus, trucks**
- **Competitors**, to know what to avoid
- **Words**: lines and headlines you wish you'd written
- **Colors** from anywhere, even a jacket
- **One thing that's just you**: a tool, a place, a band

WHAT	WHERE TO LOOK	LINK
Fonts	Google Fonts, Fontshare (free, high quality), Fonts In Use (real-world type, searchable)	fonts.google.com fontshare.com fontsinuse.com
Color	Coolors, Adobe Color, Realtime Colors (preview a palette on a real site)	coolors.co color.adobe.com realtimecolors.com
Logos and identity	Brand New by UnderConsideration (reviews of real rebrands), Branding Style Guides (archive of real brand books)	underconsideration.com/brandnew brandingstyleguides.com
Websites	Mobbin (real app and web screens), Godly, Awwwards, Land-book	mobbin.com godly.website awwwards.com land-book.com
Images and boards	Pinterest, Unsplash, Pexels	pinterest.com unsplash.com pexels.com
Design work	Behance, Dribbble	behance.net dribbble.com

Free to browse doesn't mean free to use. Fonts and photos each have a license. Google Fonts are free for commercial use, Fontshare fonts are free for personal and commercial use, and Unsplash and Pexels have their own licenses. Read the page before you put something in a logo.

STEAL FROM THE GREATS

If your folder is empty, start with brands that are famous for a reason. Don't copy the look. Ask why each decision works, then ask what the same thinking would look like for a plumber in Tulsa or a candle shop in Cartago.

BRAND	WHAT TO STEAL (THE THINKING, NOT THE LOOK)
APPLE	Restraint. One idea per screen. Huge white space. They cut more than they add.
NIKE	Belief over product. The customer is the hero. Three words: Just Do It.
AIRBNB	A clear why: belonging. A symbol simple enough to draw in the sand.
PATAGONIA	Mission first. In 2011 they ran a full-page ad that said Don't Buy This Jacket. People bought the jacket.
LIQUID DEATH	It's canned water. The brand is a heavy metal joke, done with total commitment.
MAILCHIMP	A voice guide good enough that other companies study it. Read it: styleguide.mailchimp.com
DUOLINGO	A mascot with a personality, let loose on social. Proof that weird and consistent beats safe.

PROMPT 04 • MOOD FOLDER ANALYZER (UPLOAD SCREENSHOTS)

I'm attaching **[number]** images from my mood folder: fonts, logos, brands, websites, packaging and photos I like. Analyze them like a design director who doesn't flatter clients.

1. Common threads: colors, contrast, typography, layout density, photography, textures, overall mood. Be specific.
2. Name the aesthetic I'm drawn to in 3 words, and name 2 real brands that already live in that space.
3. Pull a draft palette of 5 to 7 hex codes from the images, and tell me which image each came from.
4. Typography: classify the type I keep picking (geometric sans, grotesk, humanist sans, serif, slab, condensed display, script) and suggest free equivalents from Google Fonts or Fontshare.
5. Photo and image style: lighting, color grade, subjects, how much empty space.
6. Outliers: which images don't fit the rest and why. Ask me whether to keep or cut them.
7. Three distinct directions I could take. For each: a name, two sentences of description, palette, font pair, imagery style, and one brand it reminds you of.

Then ask me which direction feels most like me, and why. Keep in mind my business is **[what you do]** for **[who]**, and my personality words are **[3 words]**.

PROMPT 05 · REVERSE-ENGINEER A BRAND YOU LOVE

Treat [brand you admire, for example Liquid Death, Patagonia, Mailchimp or Duolingo] as a case study for someone building a small brand with no budget.

Break down:

1. Their WHY, HOW and WHAT (Golden Circle), as best you can tell from the outside.
2. Their archetype and how it shows up in copy, visuals and behavior.
3. The 3 to 5 brand decisions that do most of the work (a color, a tone, a stunt, a rule they never break).
4. Their voice: 5 example lines, and the rules you think their writers follow.
5. What they refuse to do. Brands are defined by their no's.
6. What it would look like if a [your business type] in [your town or niche] borrowed the thinking but not the look. Give me 5 specific ideas that cost under [budget].

Be honest about what only works because they have millions to spend.

STORY, ARCHETYPE, POSITIONING

The 12 brand archetypes come from Carl Jung's ideas about universal characters, turned into a branding tool by Margaret Mark and Carol Pearson in their 2001 book *The Hero and the Outlaw*. It's a shortcut, not a science. Pick one main archetype and maybe a second. If you pick five, you picked none.

ARCHETYPE	CORE DESIRE	COMMONLY CITED EXAMPLES
Innocent	Safety, simplicity, goodness	Dove, Coca-Cola
Everyman	Belonging, being normal	IKEA
Hero	Proving worth through effort	Nike
Outlaw	Breaking the rules	Harley-Davidson, Liquid Death
Explorer	Freedom, discovery	Patagonia, The North Face
Creator	Making something new	LEGO, Adobe
Ruler	Control, status, order	Rolex, Mercedes-Benz
Magician	Transformation, wonder	Disney
Lover	Intimacy, beauty, pleasure	Chanel, Godiva
Caregiver	Protecting and helping	Johnson & Johnson
Jester	Fun, joy, irreverence	Old Spice, Duolingo
Sage	Truth, wisdom, insight	Google, TED

POSITIONING IN ONE SENTENCE

For **[target customer]** who **[need]**, **[brand]** is the **[category]** that **[benefit]** because **[proof]**. Unlike **[alternative]**, we **[difference]**.

STORY RULE Your customer is the hero of the story. You're the guide. Yoda, not Luke. Nobody wants to buy from a brand that thinks it's the main character.

WRITE THE STORY

PROMPT 06 • ARCHETYPE, POSITIONING AND IDEAL CUSTOMER

Here's my brand brief: **[paste brief, or describe the business, customer and personality in a few sentences]**.

Step 1, archetype. From the 12 brand archetypes (Innocent, Everyman, Hero, Outlaw, Explorer, Creator, Ruler, Magician, Lover, Caregiver, Jester, Sage), recommend a primary and a secondary archetype for me. Explain why in plain English. Show how each choice would change my headline, my colors and my photos. Tell me which archetypes my competitors are already using so I don't blend in.

Step 2, positioning. Write 3 versions of this statement:

"For **[target customer]** who **[need or frustration]**, **[brand]** is the **[category]** that **[key benefit]** because **[reason to believe]**. Unlike **[main alternative]**, we **[real difference]**."

Mark the one that's most honest and the one that's most bold.

Step 3, ideal customer. Build a profile of one specific person: name, age range, job, a day in their life, what they've already tried, what they're sick of, the exact words they'd type into Google, where they hang out online, and what would make them trust me in 10 seconds. Then list 3 people who are NOT my customer, so I stop trying to please them.

PROMPT 07 • BRAND STORY WRITER

Using my discovery brief and why statement below, write my brand story.

[paste your discovery brief and why statement]

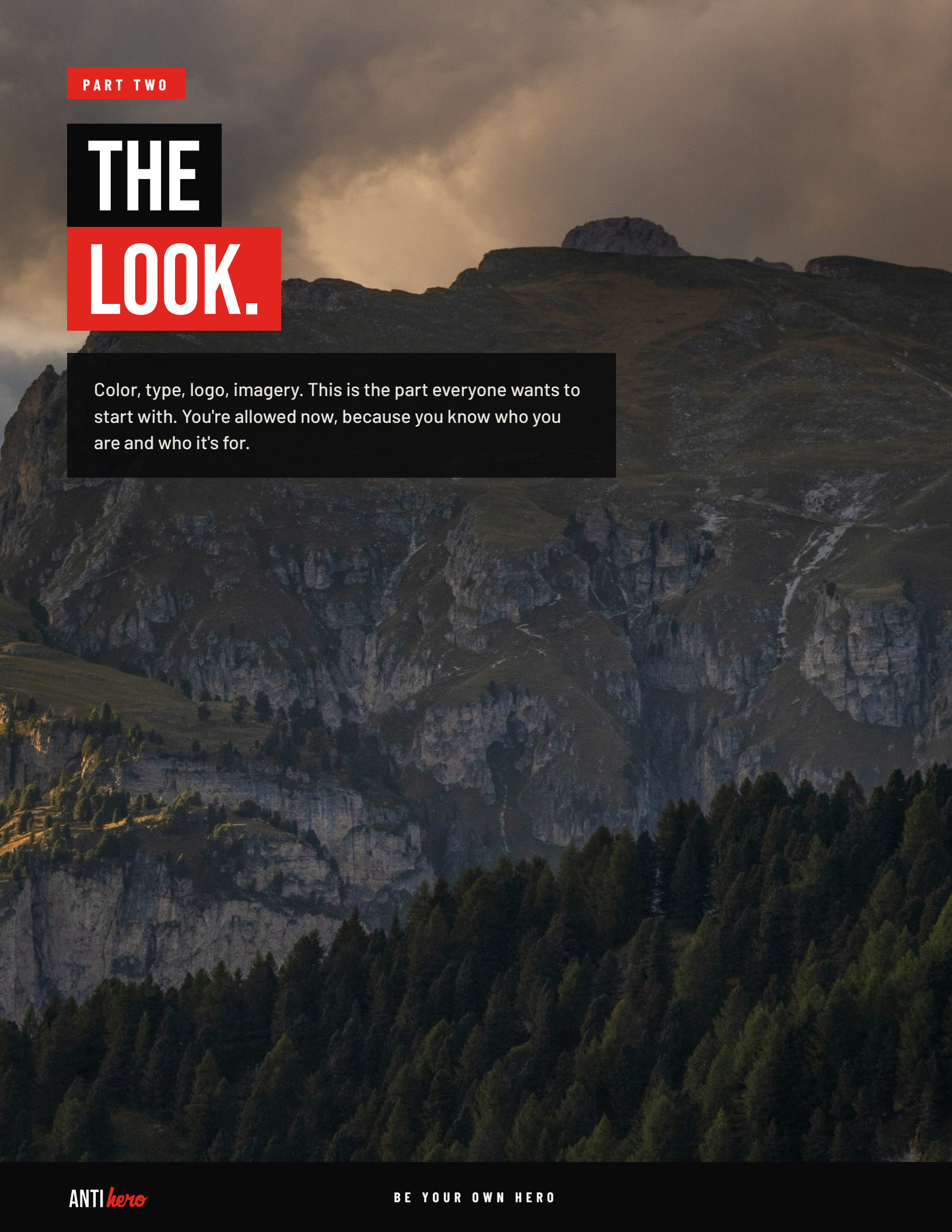
Rules:

- The customer is the hero. I'm the guide who has been where they are. (Think Luke Skywalker and Yoda, not me in a cape.)
- Structure: the world as it is, the problem that annoyed me into action, the turning point, what I do now, what changes for the customer.
- Use my archetype: **[archetype]**.
- Plain words. Real details. One specific moment beats ten adjectives.
- Banned: passionate, journey, innovative, solutions, world-class, unlock, elevate, seamless, and any sentence that could appear on a competitor's site.

Give me 3 lengths:

1. 25 words (social bio).
2. 100 words (About section, top of page).
3. 300 words (full About page), with a short headline.

Then give me a one-sentence version I can say out loud at a barbecue without sounding like a LinkedIn post.



PART TWO

THE LOOK.

Color, type, logo, imagery. This is the part everyone wants to start with. You're allowed now, because you know who you are and who it's for.

COLOR PSYCHOLOGY

COLOR	TENDS TO SIGNAL	WATCH OUT
Red	Energy, urgency, appetite, danger	Food, sports, sales, rebels
Orange	Friendly, playful, affordable	Can look cheap when overdone
Yellow	Optimism, attention	Hard to read on white. Use as an accent
Green	Nature, health, money, growth	Eco, wellness, finance
Blue	Trust, calm, competence	So common in tech and banking it's hard to stand out
Purple	Luxury, creativity, spirituality	Beauty, wellness, premium
Pink	Playful, warm, bold when hot	No longer just for girls, and hot pink is loud
Brown and tan	Earthy, reliable, handmade	Coffee, outdoors, craft
Black	Premium, power, edge	Luxury, fashion, anything with attitude
White and bone	Clean, simple, space	The silence between the notes

THE HONEST CAVEAT

Most of what you'll read online about color psychology is overconfident. The research is mixed. Meaning shifts with culture (white is weddings in much of the West and mourning in parts of East Asia), with shade (navy and baby blue are different animals) and with category. What matters more than any chart: does the color **fit your personality**, and does it **stand out from your competitors**? If every roofer in town is blue, the orange roofer gets remembered.

BUILD THE PALETTE

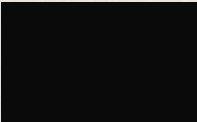
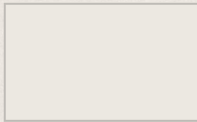
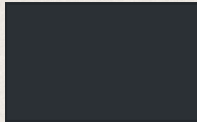
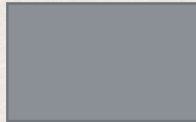
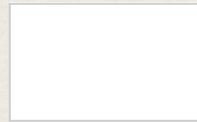
THE 60-30-10 RULE

Borrowed from interior design. **60 percent** is your dominant color (backgrounds, big areas). **30 percent** is your secondary (panels, type, supporting shapes). **10 percent** is your accent, the thing you want eyes on: buttons, one key word, the call to action. If everything is the accent, nothing is.

CONTRAST IS NOT OPTIONAL

If people can't read it, the brand doesn't exist. The accessibility standard (WCAG, level AA) asks for a contrast ratio of at least **4.5:1** for normal text and **3:1** for large text, roughly 18 point and up or 14 point bold. Check every text and background pair with the [WebAIM contrast checker](#). The full rule is at [w3.org](#).

EXAMPLE: THE ANTIHERO PALETTE

					
Anti Black #0A0A0B 60 percent. The ground.	Bone #ECE8E1 Light layouts, paper.	Graphite #2B3035 Panels, dividers.	Ash #8A9096 Captions, small stuff.	Hero White #FFFFFF Type on dark.	Ignition Red #E0261E 10 percent. One idea per layout.

Ignition Red on white is 4.7:1, so it passes for body text, barely. That's why it's used big, bold and sparingly. Write your palette down with hex codes, RGB and a job for each color. A color without a job ends up everywhere.

PROMPT 08 · PALETTE GENERATOR WITH PSYCHOLOGY

Act as a color strategist. Build my brand palette.

Brand: [name]. What we do: [one line]. Archetype: [archetype]. Personality: [3 traits]. Audience: [who].

Competitors' main colors: [list them, so we don't copy the category].

Colors I love: [list]. Colors I can't stand: [list]. Colors I have to keep: [list or none].

Give me 3 different palette options. For each one:

1. Primary, secondary, accent, plus a dark neutral and a light neutral, all with hex codes.
2. The 60-30-10 split: which color is the 60, the 30 and the 10.
3. The psychology reasoning for each color, with an honest note that color meaning depends on context, culture and shade.
4. Contrast check: give the contrast ratio for each text-on-background pair I'd actually use, and flag anything under 4.5:1 for body text or 3:1 for large headlines.
5. How it would look in real life: a website hero section, an Instagram post and a business card, described in two sentences each.

Then pick the one you'd choose for me and defend it in 3 sentences. Tell me what to avoid using these colors for.

TYPOGRAPHY

- **Two fonts, maximum.** One for headlines with personality, one for body text that disappears and lets people read. A third font is how you end up looking like a yard sale flyer.
- **Contrast, not conflict.** Pair a loud headline with a calm body. Two loud fonts fight. Two calm fonts snooze.
- **One family is a legit choice.** Bold for headlines, regular for body. Done.
- **Legibility first.** Body text at 16 px or more on screens, line height around 1.4 to 1.6, lines of roughly 45 to 75 characters. Test on your phone in sunlight.
- **Check the license.** Google Fonts and Fontshare are free for commercial use. Paid fonts can have separate terms for logos, apps and web.
- **Find your taste.** [Fonts In Use](#) shows real brands and the fonts they use. [Fontjoy](#) generates pairings to start from.

PAIRING	WHY IT WORKS	SOURCE
Bebas Neue + Barlow	Condensed display caps with a clean, friendly sans. The pair in this guide.	Google Fonts
Space Grotesk + Inter	Techy with a bit of personality, plus the most readable workhorse there is.	Google Fonts
DM Serif Display + DM Sans	Elegant headline, simple body. Designed to sit together.	Google Fonts
Fraunces + Work Sans	Warm, slightly quirky serif with a sturdy sans. Good for food and craft.	Google Fonts
Archivo Black + Archivo	One family, two moods. The easiest pairing there is.	Google Fonts
Clash Display + Satoshi	Modern, sharp, a bit fashion. Free from Fontshare.	Fontshare

PROMPT 09 • FONT PAIRING

Recommend 5 headline and body font pairings for **[brand]**, a **[business type]** whose personality is **[3 traits]** and whose archetype is **[archetype]**. Free fonts only, from Google Fonts or Fontshare, and include the link to each.

For each pairing:

1. Headline font and body font, with the weights to use.
2. Why they work together (contrast, shared proportions, mood).
3. Sizes for web: H1, H2, body and caption in px, plus line height.
4. Where it could fail: tiny sizes, numbers, all caps, other languages, long paragraphs.
5. A sample: write a headline in my voice, a subhead and a 40-word body paragraph, and tell me how it should be set.

Rules: two fonts maximum per pairing. At least one pairing must be a single family using different weights. Avoid anything that screams template (no Lobster, no Papyrus, nothing that's on every coffee shop menu). Flag any license I need to check before using a font in a logo.



TYPE	WHAT IT IS	EXAMPLES
Wordmark	The name, set in type	Google, Coca-Cola, FedEx
Lettermark	Initials	IBM, HBO, CNN
Symbol	A picture you recognize	Apple, Target
Abstract mark	A shape that means you	Nike, Pepsi
Combination	Symbol plus name	Burger King, Doritos
Emblem	Name inside a badge or crest	Starbucks, Harley-Davidson
Mascot	A character	KFC, Duolingo

THE TESTS

- **Simple.** Could a kid draw it from memory after one look?
- **Memorable.** Show it for 3 seconds, hide it, ask someone to describe it.
- **Scalable.** Still works at 32 px as a favicon and on a billboard.
- **One color.** Works in pure black and pure white. If it needs a gradient to work, it doesn't work.
- **Squint test.** Squint at it from across the room. Still a shape?
- **Mockup test.** Put it on a shirt, a van, a profile picture and a coffee cup before you fall in love.

THE FILES YOU NEED

- Master **SVG** (vector, scales forever)
- Full color on light, full color on dark
- One-color black, one-color white
- Icon or mark only
- Square profile picture (circle-safe)
- Favicon at 32 and 16 px, app icon at 512
- Transparent PNGs at 4096, 1024 and 512 px
- PDF for print

AI AND LOGOS, HONESTLY

Image models are great at concepts and still bad at letters. Use AI to explore 10 directions fast, pick one, then set the actual name in a real font in Canva or Figma, or have your AI trace it to a clean SVG. And check your favorite isn't already somebody else's trademark before you print 500 shirts.

FROM 10 IDEAS TO 1 LOGO

PROMPT 10 • 10-LOGO CONCEPT SHEET

You're a logo designer with 20 years of experience and strong opinions. Create a concept sheet of 10 genuinely different logo ideas for [brand name], a [business type] for [customer]. Personality: [3 traits]. Archetype: [archetype]. Palette: [hex codes]. Fonts: [headline font].

Spread the 10 across types:

- 2 wordmarks (the name set in type, with one custom detail)
- 2 lettermarks (initials)
- 2 symbols or pictorial marks
- 2 combination marks (symbol plus name)
- 1 emblem or badge
- 1 wildcard that breaks a rule on purpose

For each concept: a name, the idea and what it means, a description precise enough that a designer could draw it without asking questions, the font, how color is used, and how it holds up at 32 pixels and in one color.

Then [if your AI can make images]: generate the top 4 as flat vector-style images on a plain white background, centered, no mockups, no extra text. Don't worry if the lettering comes out wrong. Image models still mangle letters, and we'll set the type properly later.

Finish by ranking all 10 on simple, memorable, scalable and right for this brand, with one line on each.

PROMPT 11 • LOGO REFINEMENT AND EXPORTS

Here's the logo concept I picked: [attach the image, or describe it]. My palette is [hex codes] and my headline font is [font].

1. Critique it like a design director: what's working, what's fussy, what will break at small sizes.
2. Suggest 3 specific refinements (spacing, weight, a detail to cut, a detail to add), and show the refined version if you can make images.
3. Run the tests: does it work at 16 and 32 px (favicon), in pure black, in pure white on dark, embroidered on a hat, as a sticker, squinting from across the room?
4. Write the usage rules: minimum size, clear space, what never to do (stretch, recolor, add shadows, put it on a busy photo).

If you can work with files: trace it to a clean SVG, then export full color on light, full color on dark, one-color black, one-color white, icon only, a 512 px square app icon and a 32 px favicon, as transparent PNGs at 4096, 1024 and 512 px. Name the files like [brand]-logo-[version]-[size].png and put them in one folder.

Make favicons and app icons from your square mark with [RealFaviconGenerator](#). Lay out mockups and templates in [Canva](#) or [Figma](#).

BACKGROUNDS AND TEMPLATES

Your images do half the talking before anyone reads a word. Pick a world and stay in it. AntiHero lives in big, majestic outdoor scenes at golden hour, with calm space for the words. A bakery might live in warm close-ups and flour dust. A security company might live in night city blues. Pick yours on purpose.

IMAGERY RULES TO WRITE DOWN

- What you show, and what you never show
- Light and time of day
- Color grade tied to your palette
- Always leave calm space for text
- Real people over stock handshakes
- One illustration and icon style, or none

TEMPLATES THAT MAKE YOU LOOK CONSISTENT

- Announcement
- Quote
- Quick tip
- Event or live
- Testimonial
- Same logo spot and footer on every single one

WHY TEMPLATES MATTER

Consistency is what makes a small brand look big. When the footer, the label boxes and the colors land in the same place every time, people know it's you before they read it. That's the whole game: recognition, then trust.

PROMPT 12 • IMAGERY STYLE GUIDE AND BACKGROUNDS

Write an imagery style guide for **[brand]**. Archetype: **[archetype]**. Personality: **[3 traits]**. Palette: **[hex codes]**. Where images will be used: **[website hero, social posts, slides, print]**.

Cover:

1. Subjects we show and subjects we never show.
2. Lighting and time of day.
3. Color grade, tied to my palette (for example warm golden highlights, deep shadows, no neon).
4. Composition: always leave calm, empty space where text can sit.
5. People: real, candid, no stock-photo handshakes, no people pointing at laptops and laughing.
6. Textures, illustration style and icon style, if any.

Then write 6 image prompts I can paste into any image generator for brand backgrounds: 3 landscape at 16:9 and 3 square at 1:1. Each prompt should describe the scene, the light, the mood, the color grade, the camera angle and where the empty space is. Every prompt must end with: no text, no letters, no logos, no watermarks, no faces.

PROMPT 13 · SOCIAL TEMPLATE SYSTEM

Design a social template system for **[brand]** using my brand brain below.
[paste brand brain, or palette, fonts, logo rules and voice traits]

I need 5 templates: announcement, quote, quick tip, event or live, testimonial. Sizes: 1080 x 1350 (feed) and 1080 x 1080 (square), plus a 1080 x 1920 story version of the event template.

For each template give me:

1. The layout: where the headline, body, logo and call to action sit, with margins in px.
2. Type sizes and weights for each text element.
3. Color rules: background, text, the one accent.
4. Maximum copy length (headline words, body characters).
5. One example post written in my voice.

Then **[choose one]**: build them as HTML files I can screenshot / give me step-by-step Canva instructions / give me a Figma frame spec. Keep the logo and footer in the same spot on every template so people recognize me before they read a word.

PART THREE

THE VOICE.

How you sound is the brand people hear every day. The logo shows up once a post. The voice shows up in every caption, email, reply and apology.



BRAND VOICE

A voice guide is three traits, a list of words you never use, and examples. That's it. Example from AntiHero:

WE ARE WE ARE NOT IN PRACTICE

DIRECT	Rude	Say the thing. Then stop.
FUNNY	Clowning	Dry humor that serves the point, never jokes instead of help.
HUMAN	Sloppy	Talk like a person who knows their stuff and respects your time.

BANNED WORDS (THE AI SLOP LIST)

delve, unlock, elevate, seamless, game-changer, leverage, synergy, robust, cutting-edge, journey, tapestry, landscape, empower, revolutionize, "in today's fast-paced world", "it's not just X, it's Y", and anything that starts with "In a world where". Add your own. Tell your AI the list every time, or better, put it in your brand brain.

BEFORE AND AFTER

BEFORE (SOUNDS LIKE EVERYONE)

AFTER (SOUNDS LIKE SOMEONE)

We leverage cutting-edge AI solutions to unlock your business's full potential.

We show you how to use AI yourself, so you stop paying someone to do it badly.

DON'T MISS OUT on this game-changing opportunity. Spots are LIMITED.

It's free. Show up live or catch the replay. No guilt trip either way.

At Acme, we're passionate about delivering exceptional customer experiences.

We answer the phone. Weirdly rare. We're keeping it.

In today's fast-paced digital landscape, your brand is more important than ever.

Your brand is what people say about you when you leave the room. Let's give them better material.

TAGLINE

Short, true, and impossible for a competitor to steal without it sounding wrong. Nike: Just Do It. AntiHero: Be your own hero. Test it out loud. If it sounds like a mattress ad, start again.

SOUND LIKE YOURSELF

PROMPT 14 • BRAND VOICE GUIDE WRITER

Write the brand voice guide for **[brand]**. Here's what you need to know: **[paste brief, why statement, archetype and ideal customer]**.

Here are 3 to 5 real things I've written that sound like me on a good day: **[paste them]**. And here's one that sounds nothing like me: **[paste it]**.

The guide must include:

1. Three voice traits, each with "this, not that" (for example: direct, not rude). Two sentences on what each trait means in practice.
2. A do and don't table with 8 rows.
3. Vocabulary: words we use, words we never use. Put these on the banned list automatically: delve, unlock, elevate, seamless, game-changer, leverage, synergy, robust, cutting-edge, journey, tapestry, "in today's fast-paced world", "it's not just X, it's Y", and any sentence that starts with "In a world where".
4. Punctuation and formatting rules (exclamation points, emojis, dashes, caps, sentence length).
5. How the tone shifts by situation: sales page, social post, apology email, a complaint reply, an error message.
6. Five before and after rewrites of my own samples.

Keep it short enough that someone could read it in four minutes and sound like me by the end.

PROMPT 15 • TAGLINE GENERATOR

Write 30 taglines for **[brand]**. What we do: **[one line]**. Why: **[why statement]**. Customer: **[who]**. Voice traits: **[3 traits]**. Things competitors already say: **[list, so we avoid them]**.

Give me 5 in each of these styles:

1. Plain and true (says exactly what we do).
2. The belief (our why in a few words).
3. The challenge (an imperative, like "Be your own hero").
4. The wink (dry humor).
5. The contrast (us versus the usual way).
6. The weird one (might be terrible, might be genius).

Six words maximum each. Then pick your top 5 and test each one:

- Is it true?
 - Could a competitor put it on their site tomorrow? If yes, kill it.
 - Does it sound good said out loud?
 - Does it still work in 10 years?
 - Would my ideal customer screenshot it?
- End with your single favorite and why.

PROMPT 16 • DAILY USE: SAY IT IN MY VOICE

Read my brand brain first: **[paste or attach]**. Now rewrite this so it sounds like me: **[paste text]**. Keep the facts. Cut it by a third. No banned words. Give me 2 versions: one safe, one with a bit more edge. Tell me which line you're least sure about.

THE BRAND BRAIN

Here's the move that makes everything else pay off. Put every decision into one document: your why, customer, positioning, archetype, palette, fonts, logo rules, voice, banned words, imagery rules and templates. Then make your AI read it before it writes or designs anything for you.

- **Grok Bot:** keep it in the Bot's files and tell the Bot to read it before every brand task. It remembers.
- **ChatGPT:** put it in a Project, or paste the short version into custom instructions.
- **Claude:** add it to a Project's knowledge.
- **Gemini:** put it in a Gem's instructions.
- **Anything else:** paste it at the top of the chat. Old school, still works.

WHY IT WORKS

Without it, every new chat starts from zero and you get the average of the internet again. With it, your AI writes like you on the first try, uses your colors, skips your banned words and tells you when a request is off-brand. It's the difference between a temp and a coworker who's been there a year.

TWO VERSIONS Keep a short version (under 1,500 words) for custom instructions and a full version with logos and examples for humans and designers.

PROMPT 17 · BRAND BRAIN COMPILER

Compile my brand brain: one document that every AI and every human reads before they make anything for my brand. Use everything we've built in this conversation.

[If it's a new chat, paste: discovery brief, why statement, positioning, archetype, ideal customer, palette, fonts, logo rules, voice guide, imagery guide.]

Structure:

1. The brand in 30 seconds (5 lines a stranger could read and get it).
2. Why, How, What.
3. Ideal customer, and who we're not for.
4. Positioning statement and tagline.
5. Personality and archetype.
6. Voice: 3 traits with "this, not that", banned words, 5 example lines, punctuation rules.
7. Logo: versions, file names, minimum size, clear space, don'ts.
8. Color: every color with hex and RGB, its job, and the 60-30-10 split.
9. Typography: fonts, weights, sizes, links.
10. Imagery: style rules and 3 example image prompts.
11. Templates: what exists and where the files live.
12. Instructions for AI, written to the AI: "Before you write or design anything for [brand], read this whole document. Follow the voice rules. Never use the banned words. If a request conflicts with this guide, say so before doing it."

Output it in markdown first. Keep it under [1,500] words so it fits in custom instructions. Then [make a nicely designed one-page HTML version / a PDF using my fonts and colors].

THE CHECKLIST

- ☐ **Your why fits in one sentence** and it isn't about money.
- ☐ **You can name your customer** a specific person, not 'everyone aged 25 to 65'.
- ☐ **You know your competitors' colors and words** and you're not using them.
- ☐ **One main archetype** two at most.
- ☐ **Palette has hex codes and jobs** 60-30-10, every text pair passes contrast.
- ☐ **Two fonts, max** with sizes written down.
- ☐ **Logo works at 32 px and in one color** and you have every version exported.
- ☐ **Voice guide has banned words** and real before and after examples.
- ☐ **Templates keep the logo and footer in the same spot**
- ☐ **The brand brain exists** and your AI reads it every time.
- ☐ **You showed it to five real customers** and listened more than you defended.

PROMPT 18 • ACT AS MY BRAND DIRECTOR

Act as my brand director. You've run brands for 20 years and you're allergic to flattery. Here is my brand brain: **[paste it or attach it]**. Here is the thing I want you to judge: **[attach the logo, post, flyer, homepage or ad, or paste the copy]**.

Give me:

1. Your first impression in 3 seconds, the way a stranger scrolling past would get it.
2. An on-brand score from 1 to 10 for each: message and why, voice, color, typography, imagery, layout. One line of reasoning each.
3. The single biggest problem.
4. Three specific fixes ordered by impact. Specific means "cut the headline from 14 words to 6", not "make it pop".
5. A rewrite of the copy in my voice.
6. What to keep, so I don't throw out the good stuff.

If it's off-brand in a way that's actually better, tell me, and tell me what to update in the brand brain.

COMMON MISTAKES

MISTAKE

THE FIX

Starting with the logo	The logo is the last 10 percent. Without the why, it's decoration.
Designing for yourself	You're not the customer. Your taste matters, their gut matters more.
Copying the category leader	You'll look like the cheaper version of them.
Too many colors and fonts	Restraint reads as confidence.
Trends	Gradients and blobs date fast. Make the decision you'll still like in five years.
Being nobody	A faceless brand has to outspend everyone. You can't. Show up as you.
Letting AI pick for you	AI gives you options. You make decisions. The whole value is in the deciding.
Rebranding every six months	You get bored of your brand long before customers notice it. Consistency compounds.
Never asking real people	Five customer conversations beat fifty AI critiques.
Forgetting the boring stuff	Trademark search, domain, social handles, font licenses. Do it before the shirts.

ONE MORE TIP FROM THE PROS

Brand people judge a brand by its **least** polished touchpoint: the email signature, the invoice, the voicemail, the reply to a one-star review. That's where the brand is real. Run those through your brand brain too.

TONIGHT'S RUN OF SHOW

START	END	SEGMENT	ON SCREEN
00:00	02:00	Cold open: your brand isn't your logo	Your face, this cover
02:00	07:00	Start with why: Golden Circle, people buy you	Golden Circle page
07:00	10:00	Steal like an artist, the mood folder	Mood folder page, Fonts In Use, Brand New
10:00	15:00	DEMO 1: WHY FINDER ON A BUSINESS FROM THE COMMENTS	Grok Bot, Prompt 01
15:00	19:00	DEMO 2: PALETTE AND FONT PAIRING	Prompts 08 and 09, Realtime Colors
19:00	25:00	DEMO 3: 10 LOGO CONCEPTS, PICK ONE, REFINE	Prompts 10 and 11
25:00	29:00	DEMO 4: VOICE GUIDE AND TAGLINES	Prompts 14 and 15
29:00	33:00	DEMO 5: COMPILE THE BRAND BRAIN	Prompt 17, the finished doc
33:00	36:00	Brand director roasts something live	Prompt 18 on a viewer's logo or post
36:00	38:00	Mistakes and checklist	Checklist page
38:00	40:00	Close: one homework task, group plug	Closing page
40:00	45:00	Buffer: Q&A and demo overrun	Comments

DEMO NOTES

Before you go live, start one chat in Grok Bot, paste the guide's prompts into a note in order and pick a backup business in case nobody volunteers (a mobile dog groomer works, everyone has an opinion about dogs). Take a real business from the comments if you can. Answer the why finder questions as that owner, quickly, three or four answers is enough to show it. Let the long jobs (logo images, the brand brain PDF) run while you talk through the next section.

PRO MOVE If a demo stalls, cut to the checklist and come back. Nobody minds waiting for a logo. Everybody minds watching a spinner in silence.

PROMPT CHEAT SHEET

01 WHY FINDER	Find your one-sentence why. Asks 12+ questions, one at a time.
02 BRAND DISCOVERY INTERVIEW	The full agency-style interview. Output: Brand Discovery Brief.
03 COMPETITOR TEARDOWN	Competitors, the sea of sameness, white space.
04 MOOD FOLDER ANALYZER (UPLOAD SCREENSHOTS)	Upload your mood folder, get 3 directions.
05 REVERSE-ENGINEER A BRAND YOU LOVE	Learn from a famous brand at your budget.
06 ARCHETYPE, POSITIONING AND IDEAL CUSTOMER	Archetype, positioning statement, ideal customer.
07 BRAND STORY WRITER	Brand story in 25, 100 and 300 words.
08 PALETTE GENERATOR WITH PSYCHOLOGY	3 palettes, 60-30-10, contrast checked.
09 FONT PAIRING	5 free pairings with sizes and samples.
10 10-LOGO CONCEPT SHEET	10 concepts across logo types, top 4 rendered.
11 LOGO REFINEMENT AND EXPORTS	Polish, test, usage rules, every export.
12 IMAGERY STYLE GUIDE AND BACKGROUNDS	Image style rules plus 6 background prompts.
13 SOCIAL TEMPLATE SYSTEM	5 templates at feed, square and story sizes.
14 BRAND VOICE GUIDE WRITER	3 traits, banned words, rewrites.
15 TAGLINE GENERATOR	30 taglines, tested, one favorite.
16 DAILY USE: SAY IT IN MY VOICE	Daily: say this in my voice.
17 BRAND BRAIN COMPILER	Compile everything into the brand brain.
18 ACT AS MY BRAND DIRECTOR	Brutal, specific critique of anything.

THE ORDER THAT WORKS

01 or 02, then 03, 04, 06, 07. Then 08, 09, 10, 11, 12, 13. Then 14 and 15. Finish with 17. Use 16 and 18 forever after.

LINKS AND RESOURCES

TALKS

Simon Sinek: How great leaders inspire action (TED)	ted.com/talks/simon_sinek_how_great_leaders_inspire_action
Same talk on YouTube (TED channel)	youtube.com/watch?v=qp0HIF3SfI4
Seth Godin: How to get your ideas to spread	ted.com/talks/seth_godin_how_to_get_your_ideas_to_spread
Seth Godin: The tribes we lead	ted.com/talks/seth_godin_the_tribes_we_lead
Andrew Stanton: The clues to a great story	ted.com/talks/andrew_stanton_the_clues_to_a_great_story
Austin Kleon: Steal Like an Artist (TEDxKC)	youtube.com/watch?v=oww7oB9rjgw

READING

Simon Sinek	simonsinek.com
Austin Kleon: Steal Like an Artist	austinkleon.com/steal
Quote Investigator: hide your sources	quoteinvestigator.com/2014/06/01/creative
Marty Neumeier	martyneumeier.com
Mailchimp voice and tone guide	styleguide.mailchimp.com/voice-and-tone
Nielsen Norman Group: tone of voice	nngroup.com/articles/tone-of-voice-dimensions

FONTS

Google Fonts	fonts.google.com
Fontshare	fontshare.com
Fonts In Use	fontsinuse.com
Fontjoy	fontjoy.com

COLOR AND CONTRAST

Coolors	coolors.co
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Adobe Color	color.adobe.com
Realtime Colors	realtimecolors.com
WebAIM contrast checker	webaim.org/resources/contrastchecker
WCAG contrast minimum (W3C)	w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/Understanding/contrast-minimum.html

INSPIRATION

Brand New (UnderConsideration)	underconsideration.com/brandnew
Branding Style Guides	brandingstyleguides.com
Mobbin	mobbin.com
Godly	godly.website
Awwwards	awwwards.com
Land-book	land-book.com
Pinterest	pinterest.com
Behance	behance.net
Dribbble	dribbble.com
Unsplash	unsplash.com
Pexels	pexels.com

MAKE IT

Canva	canva.com
Figma	figma.com
RealFaviconGenerator	realfavicongenerator.net
Grok Bot	x.ai/bot
Grok	grok.com
AntiHero AI group	facebook.com/groups/antiheroai

NOW GO BE SOMEBODY.

Homework: run Prompt 01 this week and post your why in the group. One sentence. Brave is better than polished. Then build the rest, one section at a time. The AntiHero AI group is free, sells nothing, and will tell you honestly if your logo looks like a dentist's.

[FACEBOOK.COM/GROUPS/ANTIHEROAI](https://facebook.com/groups/antiheroai)

